COLD WAR AND INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

COLD WAR SECURITY DILEMMA → ORIGINS WEIGHTING → CONTAINMENT SEQUENCE → KOREAN ESCALATION → THAW VERSUS CONTROL → BERLIN AND CUBA

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 COLD WAR SECURITY DILEMMA

COLD WAR SECURITY DILEMMA | SECURITY BELT IN EASTERN EUROPE | READS BELT AS EXPANSION | USSR READS ENCIRCLEMENT | DEFENSIVE ACTS REPRODUCE HOSTILITY

USSR → security belt in eastern Europe → WEST → reads belt as expansion → CONTAINMENT → USSR reads encirclement → RESULT → defensive acts reproduce hostility

CORE CLAIM
- USSR → security belt in eastern Europe
- WEST → reads belt as expansion

MECHANISM
- CONTAINMENT → USSR reads encirclement
- RESULT → defensive acts reproduce hostility

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- USSR → security belt in eastern Europe
- WEST → reads belt as expansion

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTAINMENT → USSR reads encirclement; RESULT → defensive acts reproduce hostility.

01

STAGE 01 ORIGINS WEIGHTING

ORIGINS WEIGHTING | DEFINES FRIEND AND THREAT | POWER VACUUM | CREATES STRATEGIC STAKES | ATOMIC ASYMMETRY | RAISES MISTRUST | WARTIME LEGACY | BEGINS RIVALRY WITH LOW TRUST

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat	ATOMIC ASYMMETRY → raises mistrust	IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat
POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes	WARTIME LEGACY → begins rivalry with low trust	POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes

CORE CLAIM
- IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat
- POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes

MECHANISM
- ATOMIC ASYMMETRY → raises mistrust
- WARTIME LEGACY → begins rivalry with low trust

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- IDEOLOGY → defines friend and threat
- POWER VACUUM → creates strategic stakes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WARTIME LEGACY → begins rivalry with low trust.

02

STAGE 02 CONTAINMENT SEQUENCE

CONTAINMENT SEQUENCE | TRUMAN DOCTRINE AND MARSHALL PLAN | CZECHOSLOVAKIA HARDENS DIVISION | BERLIN BLOCKADE AND AIRLIFT | NATO, SOVIET BOMB AND COMMUNIST CHINA

1947 → Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan → 1948 → Czechoslovakia hardens division → 1948–49 → Berlin blockade and airlift → 1949 → NATO, Soviet bomb and communist China

CORE CLAIM
- 1947 → Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan
- 1948 → Czechoslovakia hardens division

MECHANISM
- 1948–49 → Berlin blockade and airlift
- 1949 → NATO, Soviet bomb and communist China

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1947 → Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan
- 1948 → Czechoslovakia hardens division

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1949 → NATO, Soviet bomb and communist China.

03

STAGE 03 KOREAN ESCALATION

KOREAN ESCALATION | NORTH INVADES | JUNE 1950 | UN/US FORCE | ADVANCES NORTH | ENTERS THE WAR | FRONTIER REMAINS NEAR 38TH PARALLEL

NORTH INVADES → June 1950 → UN/US FORCE → advances north → CHINA → enters the war → 1953 → frontier remains near 38th parallel

CORE CLAIM
- NORTH INVADES → June 1950
- UN/US FORCE → advances north

MECHANISM
- CHINA → enters the war
- 1953 → frontier remains near 38th parallel

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NORTH INVADES → June 1950
- UN/US FORCE → advances north

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHINA → enters the war; 1953 → frontier remains near 38th parallel.

04

STAGE 04 THAW VERSUS CONTROL

THAW VERSUS CONTROL | KOREAN ARMISTICE AND AUSTRIAN TREATY | RHETORIC OF REDUCED TENSION | WARSAW PACT | BLOC INSTITUTIONALISED IN 1955 | HUNGARY 1956 | SOVIET SPHERE ENFORCED BY FORCE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty	WARSAW PACT → bloc institutionalised in 1955	THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty
COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension	HUNGARY 1956 → Soviet sphere enforced by force	COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension

CORE CLAIM
- THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty
- COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension

MECHANISM
- WARSAW PACT → bloc institutionalised in 1955
- HUNGARY 1956 → Soviet sphere enforced by force

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- THAW → Korean armistice and Austrian treaty
- COEXISTENCE → rhetoric of reduced tension

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HUNGARY 1956 → Soviet sphere enforced by force.

05

STAGE 05 BERLIN AND CUBA

BERLIN AND CUBA | BERLIN WALL 1961 | DIVISION MADE PHYSICAL | CUBA 1962 | NUCLEAR CONFRONTATION PEAKS | COMMON RULE | AVOID DIRECT GENERAL WAR | STABILITY THROUGH RESTRAINT, NOT SETTLEMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical	COMMON RULE → avoid direct general war	BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical
CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks	RESULT → stability through restraint, not settlement	CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks

CORE CLAIM
- BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical
- CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks

MECHANISM
- COMMON RULE → avoid direct general war
- RESULT → stability through restraint, not settlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BERLIN WALL 1961 → division made physical
- CUBA 1962 → nuclear confrontation peaks

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMMON RULE → avoid direct general war; RESULT → stability through restraint, not settlement.

06

STAGE 06 GLOBAL COLD WAR MAP

GLOBAL COLD WAR MAP | KOREA, VIETNAM AND CHINA | LATIN AMERICA | CUBA AND CHILE | MIDDLE EAST | SUEZ AND ARAB-ISRAELI WARS | RENEWED CONFRONTATION AFTER 1979

ASIA → Korea, Vietnam and China

LATIN AMERICA → Cuba and Chile → MIDDLE EAST → Suez and Arab-Israeli wars → AFGHANISTAN → renewed confrontation after 1979

CORE CLAIM
- ASIA → Korea, Vietnam and China
- LATIN AMERICA → Cuba and Chile

MECHANISM
- MIDDLE EAST → Suez and Arab-Israeli wars
- AFGHANISTAN → renewed confrontation after 1979

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ASIA → Korea, Vietnam and China
- LATIN AMERICA → Cuba and Chile

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MIDDLE EAST → Suez and Arab-Israeli wars; AFGHANISTAN → renewed confrontation after 1979.

07

STAGE 07 MIDDLE EAST CAUSAL LAYERS

MIDDLE EAST CAUSAL LAYERS | NATIONALISM, TERRITORY AND REFUGEES | DECOLONISATION AND BORDERS | OIL AND STATE SECURITY | INTERNATIONALISE RATHER THAN CREATE ALL CAUSES

LOCAL → nationalism, territory and refugees → POST-IMPERIAL → decolonisation and borders → STRATEGIC → oil and state security → SUPERPOWERS → internationalise rather than create all causes

CORE CLAIM
- LOCAL → nationalism, territory and refugees
- POST-IMPERIAL → decolonisation and borders

MECHANISM
- STRATEGIC → oil and state security
- SUPERPOWERS → internationalise rather than create all causes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LOCAL → nationalism, territory and refugees
- POST-IMPERIAL → decolonisation and borders

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SUPERPOWERS → internationalise rather than create all causes.

08

STAGE 08 DETENTE MECHANISM

DETENTE MECHANISM | NUCLEAR RISK BECOMES UNDENIABLE | SALT I 1972 | ARMS COMPETITION REGULATED | US-CHINA OPENING | TRIANGULAR DIPLOMACY | HELSINKI 1975 | NORMS WITHOUT ENDING RIVALRY

CUBA → nuclear risk becomes undeniable → SALT I 1972 → arms competition regulated → US-CHINA OPENING → triangular diplomacy → HELSINKI 1975 → norms without ending rivalry

CORE CLAIM
- CUBA → nuclear risk becomes undeniable
- SALT I 1972 → arms competition regulated

MECHANISM
- US-CHINA OPENING → triangular diplomacy
- HELSINKI 1975 → norms without ending rivalry

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CUBA → nuclear risk becomes undeniable
- SALT I 1972 → arms competition regulated

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: US-CHINA OPENING → triangular diplomacy; HELSINKI 1975 → norms without ending rivalry.

09

STAGE 09 NON-ALIGNMENT AS AGENCY

NON-ALIGNMENT AS AGENCY | NO AUTOMATIC BLOC MEMBERSHIP | ROOM FOR INDEPENDENT POLICY | AID AND SUPPORT SOUGHT FROM BOTH SIDES | PRESSURE PERSISTS DESPITE AUTONOMY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
REFUSAL → no automatic bloc membership	LEVERAGE → aid and support sought from both sides	REFUSAL → no automatic bloc membership
SOVEREIGNTY → room for independent policy	CAUTION → pressure persists despite autonomy	SOVEREIGNTY → room for independent policy

CORE CLAIM
- REFUSAL → no automatic bloc membership
- SOVEREIGNTY → room for independent policy

MECHANISM
- LEVERAGE → aid and support sought from both sides
- CAUTION → pressure persists despite autonomy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- REFUSAL → no automatic bloc membership
- SOVEREIGNTY → room for independent policy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEVERAGE → aid and support sought from both sides.

10

STAGE 10 COMMUNIST BLOC FRACTURE

COMMUNIST BLOC FRACTURE | AFTER 1956 | SINO-SOVIET RELATIONS DETERIORATE | DISPUTE WIDENS | US-CHINA OPENING EXPLOITS THE RIFT | COMMUNIST CHINA ATTACKS COMMUNIST VIETNAM

AFTER 1956 → Sino-Soviet relations deteriorate → DOCTRINE/TERRITORY → dispute widens → 1972 → US-China opening exploits the rift → 1979 → communist China attacks communist Vietnam

CORE CLAIM
- AFTER 1956 → Sino-Soviet relations deteriorate
- DOCTRINE/TERRITORY → dispute widens

MECHANISM
- 1972 → US-China opening exploits the rift
- 1979 → communist China attacks communist Vietnam

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- AFTER 1956 → Sino-Soviet relations deteriorate
- DOCTRINE/TERRITORY → dispute widens

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1972 → US-China opening exploits the rift; 1979 → communist China attacks communist Vietnam.

11

STAGE 11 COLD WAR ANSWER SPINE

COLD WAR ANSWER SPINE | SECURITY DILEMMA READ THROUGH IDEOLOGY | BERLIN, KOREA AND CUBA DEFINE LIMITS | LOCAL CAUSES, AGENCY AND FRACTURED BLOCS | STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS PLUS REFORM AND NON-USE OF FORCE

ORIGINS → security dilemma read through ideology → CRISES → Berlin, Korea and Cuba define limits → GLOBAL → local causes, agency and fractured blocs → END → structural weakness plus reform and non-use of force

CORE CLAIM
- ORIGINS → security dilemma read through ideology
- CRISES → Berlin, Korea and Cuba define limits

MECHANISM
- GLOBAL → local causes, agency and fractured blocs
- END → structural weakness plus reform and non-use of force

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ORIGINS → security dilemma read through ideology
- CRISES → Berlin, Korea and Cuba define limits

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: END → structural weakness plus reform and non-use of force.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | FEAR OF NUCLEAR CATASTROPHE | AMERICAN EXHAUSTION AND DISAPPOINTMENT AFTER VIETNAM | WEST EUROPEAN DESIRE FOR STABILITY | TRIANGULAR PRESSURE CREATED BY CHINA-US RAPPROCHEMENT | LATER INF UNDER GORBACHEV | SS-20 VERSUS PERSHING/CRUISE MISSILE COMPETITION | FAILURE OF SALT II RATIFICATION

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- fear of nuclear catastrophe;
- American exhaustion and disappointment after Vietnam;
- West European desire for stability;
- triangular pressure created by China-US rapprochement.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- later INF under Gorbachev;
- SS-20 versus Pershing/Cruise missile competition;
- failure of SALT II ratification;
- Soviet intervention in Afghanistan;

LEGACY / NUANCE
- persistence of deep mutual suspicion.
- after the Second World War, many newly emerging states wanted to remain neutral or non-aligned in the struggle between communism and capitalism;
- in Asia, the Korean War and SEATO showed that many states wanted to stay uncommitted rather than enter bloc politics.
- Kennan / containment is central to orthodox interpretation.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels